

AI-DND

QUEST_SYSTEM.md

Dynamic Quest System

Version 0.1

1. DESIGN PHILOSOPHY

Quests are not missions.

Quests are problems.

The world creates problems.

The player decides whether to become involved.

2. QUEST ORIGIN

Quests emerge from:

- NPC goals;
 - NPC fears;
 - world events;
 - economics;
 - diseases;
 - wars;
 - rumors;
 - player actions.
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3. QUEST TYPES

Personal Quests

Examples:

- revenge;
 - family problems;
 - debts;
 - promises.
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Settlement Quests

Examples:

- famine;
 - monsters;
 - disease;
 - crime.
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Faction Quests

Examples:

- espionage;
 - war;
 - politics;
 - sabotage.
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Historical Quests

Examples:

- ancient ruins;
 - lost artifacts;
 - forgotten kingdoms.
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Survival Quests

Examples:

- escape;

- rescue;
 - medicine.
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Dynamic Quests

Generated by world simulation.

4. NO QUEST GIVERS

NPCs do not have:

"!"

above their heads.

Players discover quests through:

- conversations;
 - observation;
 - rumors;
 - events.
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5. QUEST DISCOVERY

Examples:

Player hears:

"My daughter disappeared."

Possible quest created.

Player sees:

Village burning.

Possible quest created.

Player reads:

Ancient diary.

Possible quest created.

6. QUEST STRUCTURE

Every quest contains:

- problem;
 - participants;
 - goals;
 - risks;
 - consequences;
 - expiration.
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7. QUEST EXPIRATION

Quests may expire.

Examples:

Missing child:

3 days.

Plague:

2 weeks.

War:

months.

8. QUEST FAILURE

Failure creates consequences.

Examples:

Fail rescue:

NPC dies.

Fail defense:

Village destroyed.

Fail diplomacy:

War begins.

9. QUEST SUCCESS

Success creates consequences.

Examples:

Save village:

- gratitude;
 - prosperity;
 - reputation.
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10. HIDDEN QUESTS

Some quests remain hidden.

Examples:

- conspiracies;
 - cults;
 - secrets.
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11. MULTIPLE SOLUTIONS

Every quest may have multiple solutions.

Examples:

Kill bandits.

Negotiate.

Bribe.

Report.

Ignore.

12. MORAL CONSEQUENCES

No universal morality exists.

Actions affect:

- opinions;
 - factions;
 - reputation.
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13. PLAYER CREATED QUESTS

Players may create goals.

Examples:

- revenge;
 - exploration;
 - investigation.
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14. NPC GENERATED QUESTS

NPCs create quests naturally.

Example:

Farmer loses harvest.

Problem created.

15. CHAIN QUESTS

One quest may create others.

Example:

Bandits defeated.

Bandit leader seeks revenge.

16. PERSONAL QUESTS

NPCs may ask:

- friends;
 - family;
 - trusted allies.
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17. DYNAMIC INVESTIGATION

Examples:

- murder investigation;
- conspiracy;
- theft.

No fixed solution exists.

18. WAR QUESTS

Examples:

- scouting;
 - sabotage;
 - defense;
 - diplomacy.
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19. ECONOMIC QUESTS

Examples:

- escort caravan;
 - acquire supplies;
 - stop smuggling.
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20. DISEASE QUESTS

Examples:

- find medicine;
 - quarantine;
 - identify disease.
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21. MAGIC QUESTS

Examples:

- forbidden ritual;
 - lost spell;
 - magical corruption.
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22. LEGENDARY QUESTS

Rare quests change history.

Examples:

- dragon awakening;
 - kingdom collapse;
 - ancient discovery.
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23. QUEST MEMORY

NPCs remember:

- success;
 - failure;
 - promises;
 - betrayal.
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24. QUEST JOURNAL

The journal records:

- observations;
- memories;
- clues.

Not objectives.

25. JOURNAL EXAMPLE

Instead of:

"Kill 5 wolves."

Player sees:

"The hunter believes wolves are attacking travelers near the old forest road."

26. PLAYER ABSENCE

Quests continue during Stone Sleep.

Examples:

- wars continue;
 - people die;
 - cities fall.
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27. RUMOR INTEGRATION

Rumors may create quests.

Examples:

"I heard someone discovered ancient ruins."

28. AI-DM ROLE

AI-DM creates:

- opportunities;
 - consequences;
 - complications.
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29. QUEST IMPORTANCE

Minor ↓ Important ↓ Major ↓ Historical

30. CORE QUESTION

The player never asks:

"What quest should I do?"

The player asks:

"What should I do?"

31. CORE RULE

Quests are not content.

Quests are the result of a living world.